



Beneficiary Information on the Cloud (BIC)

Transaction Facilitator

Interface Specification

Version 7.0

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1. Introduction

The Center for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) is modernizing and migrating the Medicare Enrollment and Premium Billing Systems (MEPBS) to the Amazon Web Services (AWS) Cloud platform. Part of this initiative includes the Beneficiary Information on the Cloud (BIC) Data Services and Application Programming Interface (API).

BIC allows authorized partners to:

- Retrieve information related to Medicare beneficiaries,
- Update Medicare beneficiary information, and
- Receive notifications for beneficiary related events, e.g., entitlement change, death, etc., of interest to them.

The MEPBS Transaction Facilitation (TRF) process coordinates a daily data exchange between MEPBS (source system) and the TRF Contractor (target system).

MEPBS transmits beneficiary data, including Part A, B, C, and Part D enrollment data and Part D payer data, to the TRF Contractor as a daily batch file. Pharmacies access this data to verify the active enrollment of beneficiaries filling prescriptions in a participating Part D drug program.

This document provides interface specifications for interaction between BIC and the TRF system. The topological interface diagram is in Appendix A.

NOTE: All sample beneficiary data provided is de-identified.

2. Data Services Information

2.1 TRF Batch File

BIC generates one TRF batch file daily and submits it to the TRF Contractor. The TRF file format is JavaScript Object Notation (JSON) and delimited by a new line. It has three types of records:

- Header Record – The header record is the first record of the file; the TRF batch file contains only one Header Record.
- Detail Record – The batch file may contain multiple detail records. The detail record is either update or delete type. Each detail record contains information for one beneficiary.
- Trailer Record – The trailer record is the last record of the file; the TRF batch file contains only one Trailer Record.

BIC transmits the batch file to TRF using CMS Enterprise File Transfer (EFT).

2.1.1 TRF File Header

The TRF JSON batch file has one instance of the TRF_HeaderRecord record at the beginning of the file. It is a required record and delimited by a new line. The table below lists the elements in the TRF_HeaderRecord object.

Table 1: TRF_HeaderRecord Structure

Attribute	Type	Length	Description
recordType	String	1	Attribute indicating type of record in file. Required. Value: H
transmissionDateTime	String	26	Date/Time of file transmission. Required. Format: YYYY-MM-DDTHH:mm:ss.SSSSSS

2.1.2 TRF Update Detail Record

The TRF JSON batch file has one or more instances of the TRF_UpdateDetailRecord between the batch header and trailer records for beneficiaries that need updating. A new line delimits it. The table below lists the elements in the TRF_UpdateDetailRecord object.

Table 2: TRF_UpdateDetailRecord Structure

Attribute	Type	Max Length	Description
recordType	String	1	Attribute indicating type of record in file. Required. Value: 'U'
data	Object		Attributes of the beneficiary reported. See below for the structure of TRF_UpdateDetail .
beneficiaryStatus	Array		Beneficiary Information. Maximum one occurrence. See below for the structure of TRF_BeneficiaryStatus .
claimAccountNum	String	9	Beneficiary Claim Account Number. This number identifies the primary Medicare Beneficiary under the Social Security Administration (SSA) or Railroad Retirement Board (RRB) programs.
beneficiaryKey	Number	10	System generated number used internally to represent a Medicare beneficiary.
mbi	String	11	Active Beneficiary Medicare Beneficiary Identifier (MBI).
bicCd	String	2	The Beneficiary Identification Code establishes the beneficiary relationship to a primary SSA or RRB wage earner and justifies entitlement to Medicare Benefits.
ssn	String	9	Beneficiary Social Security Number (SSN). 9 digits; No dashes.
rrbNum	String	12	Beneficiary RRB Number
gender	String	1	Beneficiary Gender Optional. Values: 1 - Male, 2 - Female, 0 – Unknown
birthDt	String	10	Beneficiary Date of Birth YYYY-MM-DD
deathDt	String	10	Beneficiary Date of Death, if available YYYY-MM-DD
firstName	String	30	Beneficiary First name
middleName	String	14	Beneficiary Middle name.
lastName	String	40	Beneficiary Surname/Last name

Attribute	Type	Max Length	Description
<i>mailingAddr</i>	Array		Beneficiary mailing address. Array of type <i>TRF_MailingAddress</i> . See below for the structure of <i>TRF_MailingAddress</i> . Maximum one occurrence.
addrLine1	String	40	Beneficiary Mailing street address line 1
addrLine2	String	40	Beneficiary Mailing street address line 2
addrLine3	String	40	Beneficiary Mailing street address line 3
addrLine4	String	40	Beneficiary Mailing street address line 4
addrLine5	String	40	Beneficiary Mailing street address line 5
addrLine6	String	40	Beneficiary Mailing street address line 6
city	String	40	Beneficiary Mailing City
stateCd	String	2	Beneficiary Mailing State Code
zipCd	String	9	Beneficiary Mailing ZIP Code
<i>entitlementPartA</i>	Array		Array of objects containing Medicare Part A Entitlement Periods information for the beneficiary. Array of <i>TRF_Period</i> objects. Maximum 10 occurrences. See below for structure of <i>TRF_Period</i> .
startDt	String	10	Beneficiary Medicare Part A Entitlement Effective Date. YYYY-MM-DD.
stopDt	String	10	Beneficiary Medicare Part A Entitlement Stop Date. YYYY-MM-DD if terminated, otherwise null returned.
<i>entitlementPartB</i>	Array		Array of objects containing Medicare Part B Entitlement Periods information for the beneficiary. Array of <i>TRF_Period</i> objects. Maximum 10 occurrences. See below for structure of <i>TRF_Period</i> .
startDt	String	10	Beneficiary Medicare Part B Entitlement Effective Date. YYYY-MM-DD.
stopDt	String	10	Beneficiary Medicare Part B Entitlement Stop Date. YYYY-MM-DD if terminated, otherwise null returned.

Attribute	Type	Max Length	Description
<i>eligibilityPartD</i>	Array		Array of objects containing Medicare Part D Eligibility Periods information for the beneficiary. Array of <i>TRF_Period</i> objects. Maximum 10 occurrences. See below for structure of <i>TRF_Period</i> .
startDt	String	10	Beneficiary Medicare Part D Eligibility Effective Date. YYYY-MM-DD.
stopDt	String	10	Beneficiary Medicare Part D Eligibility Stop Date. YYYY-MM-DD if terminated, otherwise null returned.
<i>partD_OptOut</i>	Array		Array of objects containing the Part D Opt Out Switch information. Maximum one occurrence. See below for structure of <i>TRF_PartD_OptOut</i>
isOptOut	Boolean		Part D Opt Out Switch Values: True or False
<i>otherInsurancePrimary</i>	Array		Array of objects containing Primary Other Drug Insurance information for the beneficiary. Array of <i>TRF_OtherInsurancePeriod</i> objects. Maximum 48 occurrences. See Table 3 for structure of <i>TRF_OtherInsurancePeriod</i> .
<i>otherInsuranceSupplemental</i>	Array		Array of objects containing Supplemental Other Drug Insurance information for the beneficiary. Array of <i>TRF_OtherInsurancePeriod</i> objects. Maximum 48 occurrences. See for structure of <i>TRF_OtherInsurancePeriod</i> .
<i>lowIncomeSubsidy</i>	Array		Array of objects containing Deemed/Low Income Subsidy information for the beneficiary. Array of <i>TRF_LowIncomeSubsidyPeriod</i> objects. Maximum 12 occurrences. See below for structure of <i>TRF_LowIncomeSubsidyPeriod</i> object.
indicator	String	1	Deemed/LIS Indicator Values: 'D' FOR Deemed period, 'L' FOR LIS period
startDt	String	10	Deemed/LIS Start Date YYYY-MM-DD.
stopDt	String	10	Deemed/LIS Start Date YYYY-MM-DD.
lisCopayLevel	String	1	LIS Co-Payment Level '1', '2', '3', or '4'

Attribute	Type	Max Length	Description
enrollmentMAPD	Array		Array of objects containing Medicare Advantage and/or Part D enrollment information for the beneficiary. Array of TRF_EnrollmentPeriod objects. Maximum 96 occurrences. See Table 4 for structure of TRF_EnrollmentPeriod object.
employerSubsidy	Array		Array of objects containing Employer Subsidy information for the beneficiary. Array of TRF_Period objects. Maximum 10 occurrences.
startDt	String	10	Employer Subsidy Start Date YYYY-MM-DD.
stopDt	String	10	Employer Subsidy Start Date YYYY-MM-DD
mbiHistory	Array		Array of TRF_MBI objects. Maximum 14 occurrences. See below for structure of TRF_MBI object.
mbi	String	11	Beneficiary MBI
effectiveDt	String	10	Beneficiary MBI Effective Date YYYY-MM-DD
effectiveReasonCd	String	2	Beneficiary MBI Effective Reason Code from the beneficiary most recent Beneficiary MBI period. The value indicates the reason of an MBI assignment to the beneficiary. The valid values are the following. • A = Accretion; • I = Initial bulk MBI assignment; • BA = (Special authorized); • BB = (Breach); • BP = (Provider issue); • BR = (Religious/cultural); • BT = (Medical/Identity theft); • BZ = (Other); • CA = (Special authorized); • CB = (CMS breach); • CE = (Entitlement and casework issues); • CF = (Confirmed fraud); • CT = (Medical/Identity theft); and • CZ = (Other).
endDt	String	10	Beneficiary MBI End Date, for historical MBI YYYY-MM-DD

Attribute	Type	Max Length	Description
endReasonCd	String	2	Beneficiary MBI End Reason Code from the beneficiary most recent Beneficiary MBI period. The value indicates the reason for the deactivation of an MBI for the beneficiary. The valid values are the following: • X= Cross-reference merge; • BA = (Special authorized); • BB = (Breach); • BP = (Provider issue); • BR = (Religious/cultural); • BT = (Medical/Identity theft); • BZ = (Other); • CA = (Special authorized); • CB = (CMS breach); • CE = (Entitlement and casework issues); • CF = (Confirmed fraud); • CT = (Medical/Identity theft); and • CZ = (Other).
disability	Array		Array of TRF_DisabilityPeriod objects. Maximum 10 occurrences. See below for structure of TRF_DisabilityPeriod object.
startDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD
endDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD
indicator	String	1	Values: • '1' = Disabled without End Stage Renal Disease (ESRD) (disability insurance benefits (DIB); • '2' = ESRD Only; • '3' = Disabled with ESRD (both DIB and ESRD).
hospice	Array		Array of TRF_HospicePeriod objects. Maximum 24 occurrences. See below for structure of TRF_HospicePeriod object.
startDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD
endDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD
npi	String	10	Hospice National Provider Identifier (NPI)
dialysisClinical	Array		Array of objects containing Clinical Dialysis Periods. Array of TRF_Period objects. Maximum 10 occurrences.
startDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD.
stopDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD

Attribute	Type	Max Length	Description																						
dialysisEntitlement	Array		Array of objects containing Dialysis Entitlement Periods. Array of TRF_Period objects. Maximum 10 occurrences.																						
startDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD.																						
stopDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD																						
esrdTransplant	Array		Array of objects containing Kidney Transplant Periods. Array of TRF_TransplantPeriod objects. Maximum 10 occurrences.																						
transplantDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD.																						
failDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD																						
medicaid	Array		Array of TRF_MedicaidPeriod objects. Maximum 48 occurrences. See below for structure of TRF_MedicaidPeriod object.																						
startDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD																						
endDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD																						
dualStatusCd	String	2	Dual Eligible Status Code <table><thead><tr><th>Code</th><th>Description</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>01</td><td>Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Qualified Medicare Beneficiary (QMB) only.</td></tr><tr><td>02</td><td>Eligible is entitled to Medicare - QMB and Medicaid coverage including Rx (Medicaid drug coverage criterion only applies through December 2005).</td></tr><tr><td>03</td><td>Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Specified Low-Income Medicare Beneficiary (SLMB) only.</td></tr><tr><td>04</td><td>Eligible is entitled to Medicare - SLMB AND Medicaid coverage including Rx (Medicaid drug coverage criterion only applies through December 2005).</td></tr><tr><td>05</td><td>Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Qualified Disabled & Working Individual (QDWI).</td></tr><tr><td>06</td><td>Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Qualifying Individual (QI).</td></tr><tr><td>08</td><td>Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Other Dual Eligible (Non-QMB, SLMB, QDWI or QI) with Medicaid coverage including Rx (Medicaid drug coverage criterion only applies through December 2005).</td></tr><tr><td>09</td><td>Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Other Dual Eligible but without Medicaid coverage.</td></tr><tr><td>10</td><td>Territory buy-ins.</td></tr><tr><td>99</td><td>Unknown.</td></tr></tbody></table>	Code	Description	01	Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Qualified Medicare Beneficiary (QMB) only.	02	Eligible is entitled to Medicare - QMB and Medicaid coverage including Rx (Medicaid drug coverage criterion only applies through December 2005).	03	Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Specified Low-Income Medicare Beneficiary (SLMB) only.	04	Eligible is entitled to Medicare - SLMB AND Medicaid coverage including Rx (Medicaid drug coverage criterion only applies through December 2005).	05	Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Qualified Disabled & Working Individual (QDWI).	06	Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Qualifying Individual (QI).	08	Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Other Dual Eligible (Non-QMB, SLMB, QDWI or QI) with Medicaid coverage including Rx (Medicaid drug coverage criterion only applies through December 2005).	09	Eligible is entitled to Medicare - Other Dual Eligible but without Medicaid coverage.	10	Territory buy-ins.	99	Unknown.
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10	Territory buy-ins.																								
99	Unknown.																								

Attribute	Type	Max Length	Description
<i>institutional</i>	Array		Array of <i>TRF_InstitutionalPeriod</i> objects. Maximum 48 occurrences. See below for structure of <i>TRF_InstitutionalPeriod</i> object.
startDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD
endDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD
indicator	String	1	This will be blank for institutional periods
<i>unlawfully present</i>	Array		Array of <i>TRF_UnlawfullyPresent</i> objects. Maximum 10 occurrences. See below for structure of <i>TRF_UnlawfullyPresent</i> object.
startDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD
endDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD
<i>incarcerated</i>	Array		Array of <i>TRF_Incarcerated</i> objects. Maximum 10 occurrences. See below for structure of <i>TRF_Incarcerated</i> object.
startDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD
endDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD

The table below lists the elements in the TRF_OtherInsurancePeriod object.

Table 3: TRF_OtherInsurancePeriod Structure

Attribute	Type	Length	Description
effectiveDt	String	10	Insurance Effective Date. YYYY-MM-DD
terminationDt	String	10	Termination Date YYYY-MM-DD
insurerName	String	32	Insurer's Name
policyNum	String	17	Policy Number
relationCd	String	2	Relationship Code: Values: '01', '02', '03', '04', '05', '06', '07', '08', '09', '10', '11', '12', '13', '14', '15', '16', '17', '18', '19', or '20'
rx_memberId	String	20	Rx ID Number
rx_groupNum	String	15	Rx Group Number
rx_bin	String	6	Rx Prescription Bank Identification Number (BIN)
rx_pcn	String	10	Rx Prescription Processor Control Number (PCN)

Attribute	Type	Length	Description
planTollFreeNum	String	18	Plan Toll Free Number
supplementalType	String	1	Supplemental Type Code: L = Supplemental M = Medigap N = State Program (Non-Qualified SPAP) O = OtherP = Patient Assistance Program Q = Qualified SPAPR = Charity S = AIDS Drug Assistance Program T = Federal Health Program 1 = Medicaid 2 = Tricare 3 = Major Medical
personCd	String	3	Person Code
payerOrder	Number	5	Payer Order

The table below lists the elements in the TRF_EnrollmentPeriod object.

Table 4: TRF_EnrollmentPeriod Structure

Attribute	Type	Length	Description
contractNum	String	5	Contract Number (identifies which Plan)
contractName	String	50	Contract Name
endDt	String	10	PBP End Date YYYY-MM-DD
startDt	String	10	PBP Start Date YYYY-MM-DD
programType	String	1	Code indicating the type of Medicare Part C and/or Part D enrollment. 1 – MA/Part C only; 2 – PDP/Part D only; 3 – MA & PDP

Attribute	Type	Length	Description
enrollmentSource	String	1	Enrollment Source Code: A=Part D Auto Enrolled by CMS B=Beneficiary Election C=Part D Facilitated enrollment by CMS D=System Generated Enrollment (Rollover) E=Plan submitted auto-enrollments F=Plan submitted facilitated enrollments G=Point of Sale (POS) submitted enrollments H=CMS- or Plan submitted re-assignment enrollments I=Assigned to Plan-submitted transactions with enrollment source other than any of the following: B, E, F, G, H and blank J=State Submitted MMP Passive Enrollment K=CMS Submitted MMP Passive Enrollment L=Beneficiary MMP Election N=Rollover by Plan Transaction Space=not applicable
pbpNum	String	3	PBP Number (further identifies which Plan)
rxDetails	Array		Array of objects containing 4Rx data. This will be present only when programType is 2 or 3. Array of TRF_RxDetail objects. Maximum 10 occurrences. See below for structure of TRF_RxDetail object.
bin	String	6	Rx BIN
endDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD
groupNum	String	15	Rx Group Number
memberId	String	20	Rx ID Number
pcn	String	10	Rx PCN
startDt	String	10	YYYY-MM-DD

2.1.3 TRF Delete Detail Record

The TRF JSON batch file has one or more instances of the TRF_DeleteDetailRecord between the batch header and trailer records for beneficiaries that need deleting. A new line delimits it. The table below lists the elements in the TRF_DeleteDetailRecord object.

Table 5: TRF_DeleteDetailRecord Structure

Attribute	Type	Length	Description
recordType	String	1	Attribute indicating type of record in file. Required. Value: 'D' for Delete
claimAccountNum	String	9	Beneficiary Claim Account Number.
bicCd	String	2	The Beneficiary Identification Code establishes the beneficiary relationship to a primary SSA or RRB wage earner and justifies entitlement to Medicare Benefits.
beneficiaryKey	Number	10	System generated number used internally to represent a Medicare beneficiary.
mbi	String	11	Active Beneficiary Medicare Beneficiary Identifier (MBI).

2.1.4 TRF File Trailer

The TRF JSON batch file has one instance of the TRF_TrailerRecord record at the end of the file. It is a required record and delimited by a new line. The table below lists the elements in the TRF_TrailerRecord object.

Table 6: TRF_TrailerRecord Structure

Attribute	Type	Length	Description
recordType	String	1	Attribute indicating type of record in file. Required. Value: 'T' for Trailer
detailRecordCount	Number	10	Number of detail records in the file.
updateRecordCount	Number	10	Number of TRF Update detail records in the file.
deleteRecordCount	Number	10	Number of TRF Delete detail records in the file.

3. Assumptions/Constraints/Risks

3.1 Assumptions

- Update record includes all the data associated with a Beneficiary when any of the fields that are in the update interface update for a beneficiary.
- There is no file created if beneficiary data update has not occurred since the last generation of the TRF file.
- The JSON file does not include attributes without a value.
- The CMS Consolidated Information Technology Infrastructure Contract (CITIC) contractor is responsible for management of the EFT process used by this interface.
- After the CME database receives updates from Enrollment Database (EDB) and Medicare Advantage Prescription Drug System (MARx), CME creates and sends the outbound file daily.

3.2 Constraints

- None.

3.3 Risks

- None.

Appendix A: BIC-TRF Topological Interconnect Diagram

The figure below displays the interconnectivity between the BIC and TRF systems.

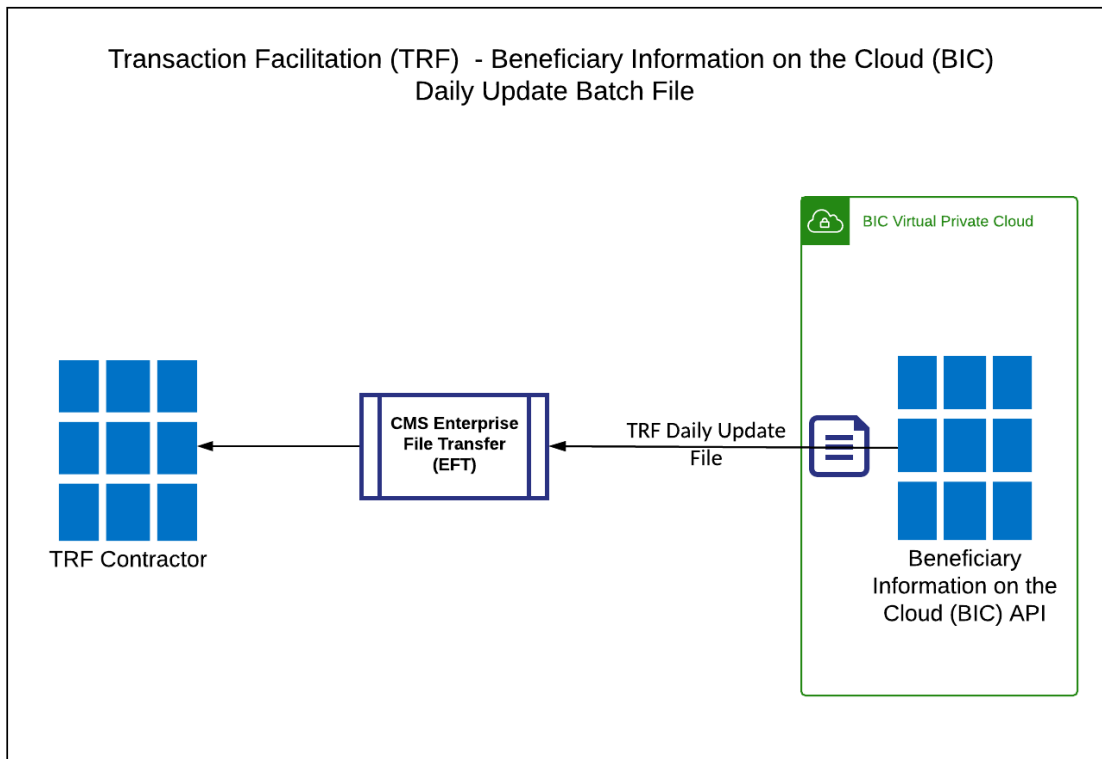


Figure 1: BIC-TRF Data Exchanges

Appendix B: Record of Changes

Table 7: Record of Changes

Version Number	Date	Author/Owner	Description of Change
1.0	03/20/2020	Laura Anto/NGC	Baseline Version
1.1	04/03/2020	Laura Anto/NGC	Updated Tables 3 and 7 based on feedback from TRF team Added the following attributes to Delete record: • MBI, activeMBI, beneficiaryKey Added the following attributes to Update record: • BeneficiaryKey • Combined enrollmentPartC and enrollmentPartD into a single type enrollmentMAPD
2.0	04/20/2020	Laura Anto/NGC	Added new table 7 for the TRF_UpdateDetailRecord class model. Corrected inconsistencies between Table 3 and Table 8. Added field length for all attributes
3.0	05/12/2020	Laura Anto/NGC	Updated the definition of the following objects: • 'data' object within the TRF_UpdateDetailRecord • TRF_OtherInsurancePeriod • TRF_DeleteDetailRecord Removed the class models.
4.0	05/19/2020	Laura Anto/NGC	Replaced Health Insurance Claim Number (HICN) with claimAccountNumber and bicCd for DeleteDetailRecord. Corrected length of MBI to 11.
5.0	06/19/2020	Laura Anto/NGC	Updated Table 6 to add the following attributes to the Trailer Record: • updateRecordCount • deleteRecordCount
6.0	04/20/2022	L. Anto/Peraton	Updated Table 2, Institutional indicator will always be blank.
7.0	02/07/25	S.Beachnau/Peraton	Updated Table 3, corrected field order and added supplementalType Table 4 corrected field order and added enrollmentSource

Appendix C: Acronyms

Table 8: Acronyms

Acronym	Literal Translation
API	Application Programming Interface
AWS	Amazon Web Services
BIC	Beneficiary Information on the Cloud
BIN	Bank Identification Number
CITIC	Consolidated Information Technology Infrastructure Contract
CMS	Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services
EDB	Enrollment Database
EFT	Enterprise File Transfer
HHSM	Health and Human Services Management
HICN	Health Insurance Claim Number
ID	Identifier
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation
MARx	Medicare Advantage Prescription Drug System
MBI	Medicare Beneficiary Identifier
MEPBS	Medicare Enrollment and Premium Billing Systems
MMA	Medicare Modernization Act
NHC	Nursing Home Care
PCN	Processor Control Number
QDWI	Qualified Disabled & Working Individual
QI	Qualified Individual
QMB	Qualified Medicare Beneficiary
RRB	Railroad Retirement Board
Rx	Prescription

Acronym	Literal Translation
SLMB	Specified Low-Income Medicare Beneficiary
SSA	Social Security Administration
SSN	Social Security Number
TRF	Transaction Facilitation